

# The Glorious Lamp of Suchness, the King of the Great Yoginī Tantras

Śrī Tattva Pradīpaṃ Nāma Mahāyoginī Tantra Rāja · Toh 423 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་དཔེ་མོ་ཉེ་གཉིས་མ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་རྣམས་འབརྩེ་ཆེ་མའི་རྩ་གཉིས་པོ་

Toh 423 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Tattva Pradīpa and in Tibetan as the Dpal de kho na nyid kyi sgron ma, rendered in English as the Glorious Lamp of Suchness. It belongs to the class of Yoginī tantras, the highest division of the Anuttarayoga tantras, and is designated a "King of the Great Yoginī Tantras," signaling its authoritative standing within that tradition. The text opens in the characteristic sūtra style — "Thus did I hear at one time" — before establishing its tantric setting: the Blessed One abiding within the bhaga of wisdom together with Vajradhātṛvīśvarī and a vast assembly of yoginīs, framing the ensuing teachings within the ritual and contemplative world of Vajrasattva and the female buddha-consorts. As a Yoginī tantra, its concerns center on the nondual union of method and wisdom, the nature of reality (tattva), and the practices of great bliss associated with the mandala of heroines.

In the language of India: Śrī Tattva Pradīpaṃ Nāma Mahāyoginī Tantra Rāja. In the language of Tibet: The Glorious Lamp of Suchness, the King of the Great Yoginī Tantras.

Homage to the glorious Vajrasattva.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, the vajra body, speech, and mind of all the Tathāgatas, together with the great heroic vajra-lord and the queens of the heroines, abided within the bhaga of wisdom. There the Blessed Lady Vajradhātviśvarī, delighting in the play of great bliss with graceful pleasure, caused the Blessed One to be stirred by the nectar of the lip-elixir. Rising from the union of the method of embrace, she circumambulated three times together with yoginīs equal in number to the dust-particles of the sun orbiting Mount Meru, and bowing her head at the feet of the Blessed One, she spoke these words:

Blessed One, renowned as the moon of wisdom,  
you who open the lotus of the navel —  
may the great sovereign lord reveal to me  
all that I wish to ask.

The glorious, unsurpassed tantra,  
supremely famed as the Yoginī —  
the meaning of the syllables evam mayā and so forth:  
how is that to be expressed?

The Blessed One declared: Listen, O goddess of long beautiful eyes. You have requested of me by hand. By the syllables evam mayā and so forth, all beings within the three realms, moving and still, are sealed by the nature of wisdom and skillful means, and not by another. Known as the Lamp of Suchness, it is the form of the immaculate and perfect fruit.

Evam, mayā, and suchness itself — these three: first, together with self, and distinctively within the four natures, are to be understood at the ultimate level.

The meaning heard is blissful as the moon. That is supreme, like space. What is called the one is supremely excellent among others, having abandoned saṃsāra and nirvāṇa. Time is the great seal, free from arising and completion. The Blessed One is called the extreme — the reality experienced by self-delight. All wisdom: three, emptiness. That suchness is abandoned by suchness itself. The Tathāgata is known as Discriminator, perfecting the original abode. Body is renowned as the form of bliss, free from the arising of the two sense faculties. Speech is called manifest joy, abandoned through what arises from samaya. Mind is called the joy that is free from joy, free from the bliss arising from gnosis — taught as the vajra of co-emergence, abandoned by its intrinsic nature.

O great glorious goddess born from the sun, the request is free from the freedom from joy. The queen of heroines, She Who Rests on Bliss, is born from the primordial nectar. Perfectly encircled by all limbs, pervasive like the lotus of the vital breath — the home of the five gates of the Brahmā of wisdom, in order to hold the gnosis of Brahmā. Through the destruction of the object of the bhaga, or through experiencing enjoyment — abiding in one's own essential nature, remaining or departing.

Such is the ultimate meaning; thus it has been explained to me and so forth. Everything is hidden within the tantra of yoga, and likewise in the yoga guru. The distinction between definitive and interpretable meaning resides in evam mayā and so forth — for the sake of knowing the tantra, the tantra of twofold division is supremely taught. The fruit is the taste of great gnosis, the very identity of self-experience. Since it is not found by pure self-knowing, all conceptuality is utterly abandoned.

The goddess asked: Blessed One, you yourself are the king of gnosis, destroyer of the darkness of distorted gnosis. Those twenty-two suchnesses that are spoken of as gnosis-drops — concerning those as well, may the supreme sovereign reveal to me their definitive meaning.

The Blessed One declared: Whatever is the definitive meaning of suchness, O Beautiful Face, that is secret. I have explained it for your sake. If it were otherwise, it would be concealed.

At the center of the Evaṃ form, whatever is the channel-wheel (Skt. cakra) of sixty-four petal shapes at the root — that is consciousness endowed with aspects. Within that, wherever the wheel of the form of a blue lotus with thirty-two channels has its identity — that is the periphery. Upon it, whatever is the hub of octagonal form — that is luminosity. Whatever is the wide open space at the center of the hub — that is the sky. There, from five-times-two up to fifteen is the ground, or the lord of sovereigns abides.

There, whatever has the identity of the three suchnesses — that is the consciousness of the aggregate that descends three times, divided into three by mind, mental factors, and the form of ignorance, and it blazes at the first corner for the duration of one watch.

Whatever is the staff of the vital wind — that, in the form of a chain-like series, through thirty-two knot-slackenings and the form of fine drops of a single taste, liquefies the nectarous marrow of the staff at the second corner for the duration of two watches.

Those six — of generation and completion, renowned as the six joys — drip at the third corner for the duration of three watches.

Whatever is the arising and dissolution of the drop — that life force, known as absorption and enjoyment, blazes at the fourth corner for the duration of four watches.

Whatever is the practice of transference — the sovereign power in which bodhicitta is gathered with petals above and below — liquefies at the fifth corner for the duration of five watches.

Whatever is the arising of the channel-wheel — nectar extending to all the limbs — drips at the sixth corner for the duration of six watches.

Whatever is the sequence of empowerment — the single vital force descending to the mouth of the vital force and then flying forth and pervading — blazes at the seventh corner for the duration of seven watches.

Whatever is the protective wheel — nectar revolving within the knots of the little fingers — liquefies at the eighth corner for the duration of eight watches.

All of these, mounted on the leftward-circling vital wind, from the arising of the sun until between night and day, become the heat of the thirty-two increasing. Among the thirty-two, the characteristic of the sixteen departures is unclear, while the characteristic of the sixteen joys is clear; for the sake of that meaning, the characteristic of the joy of joyless joy — the essential nature of the Ā-li — is the moon. The outer and its objects are to be understood as the inner abiding and its objects. This too is reckoned by the outer count of lunar days and by the inner count of vital-wind breaths.

The goddess asked: Blessed One, upon the form of the thirty-two water-born blue lotus, where the practice of great bliss abides by way of definitive meaning — I beseech the supreme sovereign to bestow his grace on this.

The Blessed One declared:

Listen, O goddess, fortunate one,  
the supreme great secret gnosis —  
whoever comes to know it alone  
becomes lord sovereign of the entire earth.

Whatever is the very mantra of the essence,  
that is the self-nature of the sixteen blisses.  
Conventionally it is the light of the hare-marked moon;  
ultimately it is like space.

Whatever grants the supreme of the eight bodies —  
that is the supreme of the eight nights.  
O goddess, or again the eight gnosises  
arise from the two of night and day.

Whatever is the sovereign power of absorption and enjoyment —  
that is, be certain, the generation stage.  
O goddess, the generation stage is luminous:  
great bliss arising from the sequence.

O fortunate one, whoever is the gnosis body —  
that is free from the sequence and its ancillaries,  
divided into four limbs or six divisions,  
or the stages of generation and completion.

O goddess, whatever is the secret sound —  
that is free from the three gnoses,  
or else three self-natures other than those,  
because gnosis of the junctures exists.

O goddess, whatever is the samaya (Skt. samaya) —  
protection and so forth, that is certain.  
It is to be grasped at the center of bliss,  
or as the object within.

Whatever is the ultimate burnt offering —  
That is the syllable HA, arising suddenly —  
and also the bindus at the center of the flow,  
wherever they dissolve in an instant.  
Whatever is the churner and the method of churning,  
that has abandoned initial joy.  
O goddess, likewise it is not the final either.  
Free from both first and last,  
O fortunate one, whatever is the recitation of mantra —  
that is the mind that has passed beyond existence,  
yet is not the abode of nirvāṇa;  
free from the two essential natures of the two,  
it is taught through eight abodes.

That is the lotus not yet opened,  
arising through the power of the abode —  
by proximity it quickly opens.  
Whatever is the sequence of joy and so forth,  
that is divided into two sequences:  
the first, in terms of the form-endowed,  
the tenth is lord of the form-free.

Whatever is the charnel ground free from conceptuality,  
where exhalation and the rest are fully abandoned —  
the bodhicitta plays there,  
and melts, for the sake of samaya.

O goddess, whatever is the riverbank,  
that is the far shore of the non-conceptual mother;  
or else there the vital channel —  
because the river of bliss flows down.

Whatever is the gnosis of luminosity and so forth,  
that is the mind endowed with joy.  
The forms of earth, water, and light,  
likewise the essential nature of wind —  
whatever is the support of an entity and the like,  
know that as the beginning of bliss;  
the distinction of its own aspect,  
or discern it through precise analysis.

O goddess, whatever are the eight charnel grounds,  
that is called the dissolution into bliss —  
the body that grasps conceptual thought  
dissolves and dissolves into it.

Whatever is the meaning of wood and so on,  
that is the cause of the primary nectar;  
the form supported by that channel is renowned.  
She who gives bliss in all its aspects —  
whatever is the wind, that very essence of meaning:  
that is the bliss of the jeweled anklet.  
With a smile, precisely,  
the lotus face is experienced.

O goddess, whatever is the finger and so forth,  
that is the upward-moving wind,  
or else, through the practice of all the channels,  
it holds the nectar of the migrating beings.

Whatever is the samādhi connected to the nearly-gone,  
that causes the moon to move upward;  
or else, having divided the four Brahmā abodes,  
it requests the departure from consciousness.

Whatever is the gnosis bindu itself,  
that is free from six, half, and three;  
the grounds of ten and fifteen  
are free from transfer, free from arising, sovereign.

Whatever is the supreme of one's own essential face,  
that is the fruit that is decisively the fourth;  
or else it is experienced as torya —

it is expressed by the term "fruit."

Whatever governs the ground,  
that is suchness with six intrinsic natures;  
from six suchnesses, three suchnesses;  
from three suchnesses, one single intrinsic nature.

Whatever is the Tathāgata's body,  
that has the characteristic of nirvāṇa;  
or else it is free from joy —  
the essential nature that is beyond joy, beyond non-joy.

O goddess, whatever reveals the tantra,  
that is the extreme increase of bliss —  
a bliss free from bliss,  
or else it is the attainment of suchness itself.

Whatever is the intrinsic nature of the great mudrā,  
that — such as dissolution and the rest — transcends the mind;  
it is the essential nature experienced by oneself,  
having abandoned grasping at meditative concentration.

Whatever is the ultimate secret,  
that is joy free from joy;  
or else it is inner tactile sensation —  
free from tactile sensation, without conceptuality.

Whatever is the meaning of the invitational offering,  
from that arises stainless bliss;  
it arises again from the past,  
and upon that arising, it increases.

O goddess, whatever is wisdom and gnosis,  
that is bliss at the mouth and at the heart:  
the mouth is ever wisdom,  
and the heart is said to be gnosis.

Whatever is the retinue of the secret maṇḍala,  
that is the virtue of semen without transfer;  
or else it is the essential nature of great bliss,  
free from the conceptual elaborations of bliss.

O goddess, whatever is the extended verse —  
the bird-faced one, let it be understood inwardly;  
or else the verse is the unmelted fluid,  
and the joy of the expanded is supreme.

Whatever is the torma as protection of the elements,  
that is the slaying of the living creature.  
The cutting — that is the supreme abode,  
it is what brings the migration of beings to a halt.

All of these are the definitive meaning of the treasury of nectar of the great  
bliss king — the suchness of the essential nature of the forty Blessed Lady  
Goddesses of the supreme great secret of the great secret.

The goddess asked: That very suchness of the nature of the forty is utterly  
intangible and difficult to grasp. It is known only somewhat by the sovereign  
lord of the earth, and fully known by the supreme sovereign lord.

The Blessed One declared:

Thirty-six — the attainment of variety —  
eleven are the sovereigns of the earth.  
Thirty-seven — the attainment of joy —  
twelve are spoken of as the sovereigns of the earth.  
Thirty-eight — the attainment of supreme joy —  
these are attained by the thirteenth.  
Thirty-nine and beyond, reaching to the end —  
the earth is the attainment of the fourteenth.  
Forty is co-emergent —  
the sovereign lord of the attainment of the fifteenth.  
That which is the sixteenth —  
inexpressible, like space —  
therein is the supreme sky of the sovereign lord,  
omniscience, difficult to attain,  
undefiled, without transfer, at peace,  
birthless — more wondrous than the wondrous.

The goddess asked: O Blessed One, what is the time of thoroughly engaging  
with the suchness of the treasury of nectar — the nectar king of great bliss —  
that is the essential nature of the thirty-two? What is the convergence? And  
what is the experience?



The Blessed One declared: Within the essential nature of the thirty-two, over the span of thirty-two hours, the arising of the two winds — the life-wind and the exertion-wind — is the thorough engagement. At the time when the exertion-wind arises, the life-wind that pervades all the limbs arises in a leftward circulation, causing the form of the utpala lotus to fold inward, and enters through the root-stalk of the navel's inner core. By that very entry, what is characterized as being of a single flavor with the king of the life of great bliss that abides within the eight-petaled center — that is the convergence. At that time, the gnosis that is without the distinction of self and other, free from the elaborations of non-duality, that sees all — that is the experience.

The goddess asked:

Whatever is attained from experience —  
what is that sovereign lord like?

That which is gained through experience —  
please explain it briefly.

The Blessed One declared:

That question is supremely wondrous.

Hear it, O goddess of beautiful, far-seeing eyes —  
what is gained through experience,

O queen of joy, is inexpressible.

It is experienced from the mouth of the guru;  
it is attained through empowerment.

The goddess asked: There are many empowerments, clearly set out in detail throughout the various tantras. What are the distinctions here? To whom is each to be given?

The Blessed One declared:

In terms of the distinct fruits of joy,  
let the empowerments first be divided into four.

The first, endowed with joy,  
is to be given to the beginner.

The second, endowed with supreme joy,  
to one who has attained the three luminosities.

The third, endowed with the third joy,  
is given to one who has definitively attained the Dharma cloud.

That called the universally proclaimed —

the fourth attainment — is to be given to that one.

The goddess asked: O Blessed One, if such is the sequence of empowerments for those who have attained luminosity, supreme joy, and the Dharma cloud and all-pervading radiance — then how does it stand for those who have not yet attained the grounds and so forth?

The Blessed One declared: For those who have not yet attained the grounds and so forth, it is in accordance with their own essential nature in the beginning. For those who have attained the grounds and so forth, it is in accordance with their own ultimate essential nature. Why? Because for them, by the power of diligence and through the blessing of exceeding merit, it is attained by the mere sight of the great gnosis free from activities and the rest. Just as a fully ripened lotus blooms by the mere touch of sunlight, so too is it for those who are fully ripened — but not for those who are not yet ripened.

The goddess asked: For those who are not yet ripened, what is the time of full ripening?

The Blessed One declared:

By accumulating merit through generosity and the rest,  
and through the definitive instruction of the supreme teacher,  
that is the time of ripening for the fortunate one.

From that, unsurpassed awakening —  
whatever attains the unsurpassed abiding place —  
thereafter, nothing more need be trained in.

The abode of the great unsurpassed gnosis:  
that is seen without effort.

Just as by the mere rising of the sun  
the various forms are made visible,  
so too by the light of the unsurpassed  
the great gnosis is made visible.

The great gnosis is free from body,  
non-dual, like space.

It is not form — body, speech, or mind —  
and is utterly free from sound and the rest.

It is without parallel, parted from space,  
free of both saṃsāra and nirvāṇa,

beyond the gross and the subtle and the like.  
It is like rain, yet free from drops.  
It is a mode and yet not merely a mode.  
It is freed from the abode of the supreme and the other supreme.  
Birthless and deathless —  
this is the perception of the supremely wondrous.

The goddess asked: O Blessed One, sovereign of great gnosis, upon obtaining the utterly pure unsurpassed awakening, is there yet another abode of great gnosis that is beyond words to be obtained?

The Blessed One declared: O mother of innumerable buddhas, why do you ask such a thing? Why do you not know the great gnosis that is beyond words? If that is so, then even my own essential nature is something you do not truly know.

The goddess said: Your essential nature I do know. Yet I was asking about something else. What is there other than the awakening of sentient beings that the sovereign of the supreme has obtained?

The Blessed One declared:

Is there anything other than the obtaining of awakening?  
O fair-faced one, is there something obtained?  
And yet within that there is seeing —  
like amṛta within fat.

The goddess said: O Blessed One, sovereign of heroic heroism, you bestow gnosis that is intrinsic nature. I will ask another question, so please grant me your gracious teaching. What is that gnosis of the fourth stage of the empowerment sequence? It is just so, just as it is. Regarding its genuine meaning, please speak it to me, O Vajradhara.

The Blessed One declared:

The fourth itself is known as the essential nature.  
Such, then, is the perception of gnosis.  
Likewise, "arisen from gnosis" —  
arisen from gnosis is bliss at the navel.  
O goddess, gnosis is at the mouth.  
Arisen from gnosis is at the throat as a necklace.  
The throat is known as the essential nature of enjoyment.

At the heart it is called the empowerment.  
What dissolves is to be known as the mouth.  
This is the aspect of the generation stage.  
Or again, the sound of "just as it is"  
has already penetrated to the genuine wisdom.  
Thus, by the view of gnosis,  
having drawn it in and placed it at one's own mouth,  
having brought it to the lotus seat at one's own heart,  
one then experiences it oneself.  
In that very instant the gnosis is bliss —  
free from conceptual elaboration, without discursive thought.  
Having seen all with mind,  
contemplate it as like space.  
Then, having also abandoned that contemplation,  
there is afterwards no contemplation whatsoever.  
That itself is great-bliss gnosis,  
seen like the moon in the sky.  
O goddess, that is the perfection stage —  
it is to be known as the ultimate.

The goddess said: O Blessed One, O sun of precious gnosis, fulfiller of all wishes, please, O great lord, bestow the teaching on the four luminances in their sequential order.

The Blessed One declared:

The four luminances abide in sequential order.  
They are the perceptions of mind and mental factors.  
From these, ignorance arises.  
The perception at the boundary has defining marks.  
Daytime in nature arises from mind.  
Mind itself is the essential nature of night.  
Genuine light is free from the three.  
Innate gnosis is the defining mark.  
When the mind thinks at the level of Brahmā,  
O goddess, that is when daytime occurs.  
When from that the life-force moves on —

At that time night abides below.  
It is neither above nor below.  
At that time the boundary is to be recalled —  
that too is renowned as fire in nature.  
The life-force keeper resides in the sun.  
That which causes the sun to exist  
will arise as the east from luminance.  
Luminance is taught as the moon.

The nectar of complete dissolution stirs.  
Because the Great Goddess stirs,  
separation from joy is renowned as supreme joy.  
Where interruption dissolves,  
the time when supreme joy arises —  
that is the joy of the first luminance.  
From that, the supreme becomes clear.  
Because it is secret, luminance is renowned as increase.

Without dissolution, without stirring — that is fullness.  
In fullness there is a subtle substance,  
whether conferring bliss or all-pervading.  
What is attained is from all-pervading.  
The beautiful-faced one is by luminance.  
That is renowned as the boundary,  
for it abides in the central station.  
Abiding at the central station,  
it therefore performs all-pervasive activity.  
The center is that which mindfulness  
gathers all things together into.  
Or else: wherever night  
has not arisen and the sun has set —  
that is known as the boundary of the center,  
the one who by her nature bestows joy.  
That itself is the attainment of luminance.  
It is the cause of the arising of all.

Wherever, in an instant at the boundary of the center,  
the feeling of bliss is not cognized —  
there, O fortunate goddess,  
what is free from joy becomes clear.

One who knows that experience  
does not make even the slightest mistake.  
Through not knowing, the fortunate one  
causes it to be without root and without basis.  
Root is to be recalled as luminance.  
The form of the essence is the moon.  
Since bliss arises from the churning  
of the great treasure-treasury of great-bliss nectar,  
O goddess, the luminance of the flower increases.  
Because it is red, it is called the sun.  
Because of the ripening of great bliss,  
the red form arises before.  
It is renowned as the attainment of the fruit,  
endowed with major marks and minor marks.  
Because it is free from what is real and what is not real,  
the beautiful-faced one is the gnosis of the boundary.  
Daytime is renowned as the circle of luminance increasing.  
Nighttime, luminance is nirvāṇa.  
Free from existence and nirvāṇa,  
the boundary is the attainment of luminance.  
Such is the supreme great secret.  
It was not made clear anywhere before.  
But because it is done for you, the fortunate one,  
the precious gnosis is made clear.  
The goddess asked: What is that very jewel of the fruit, O sovereign lord, and  
how is it found?

The Blessed One declared:

What is that jewel of the fruit?  
It abides divided into two.  
One is of the nature of supreme joy,  
and one is apart from supreme joy.  
What is renowned as the very nature of supreme joy  
is obtained through experience.  
What is apart from supreme joy  
becomes vividly clear from itself.

O fortunate goddess, whoever experiences —  
that is the nature of fullness.  
Fullness that is not experienced —  
that no one, anywhere, knows.

Just as a girl comes of age,  
if there is no man, it never occurs.  
The bliss that Legyes experiences  
Legyes the queen does not cognize.  
Whatever arises through intention and so forth —  
that is the defining mark of what is generated.  
What is free from generation and from fullness —  
that is the nature of the supreme fruit.

Whoever meditates upon that  
in what is most subtle, most supreme —  
whoever finds the unsurpassed —  
that mother of beings does not exist.  
The great unsurpassed gnosis,  
free from the four, arises always.  
Beyond that which arises always, what else is there?  
Is there anywhere any meditation?

If through whatever meditation  
no distinctive quality arises —  
because it does not arise, in meditative concentration,  
if a distinctive quality were to come —  
that would not be the nature of suchness.  
That it is not suchness, there is no doubt.  
Suchness is not meditated upon; suchness —  
who would wish to find it?  
That is like the supreme queen  
drawing a picture in the sky.

The goddess asked: This tantra of the great secret — is it to be known and  
taught and received?

The Blessed One declared:

In the northern direction, at the glorious vajra-seat of Oḍḍiyāna, one known as  
King Indrabhūti will know it, teach it, and make it clear to sentient beings.

The goddess asked: O Blessed One, this great king known as Indrabhūti — is he then the sovereign of the gods? Please declare it.

The Blessed One declared: That very king Vajrapāṇi whom I have revealed in the Glorious Tantra of the Wisdom-Drop — that very one is Indrabhūti, the sovereign over the ten grounds through his emanation body, and the sovereign over the fourteen grounds through his wisdom body.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, a number of blessed ones equal to the dust-motes of the sun above Mount Meru rose together from their seats, circumambulated three times, bowed their heads to his feet in prostration, and made offerings of manifold worship through their own miraculous powers. Then they offered this praise:

May the supreme excellence — the essential heart of the ocean of the nectar of suchness — be victorious!

May the supreme excellence — the body of wisdom, skylike, unborn, formless, beyond expression — be victorious!

May the supreme excellence — that wondrous reality in which existence and non-existence are of one taste in essential nature, the supreme treasure — be victorious!

May the supreme excellence — emptiness that is not emptiness, consummated by the light of the highest and the other highest — be victorious!

Having praised him with such a king of praises, the entire retinue together with the Blessed One became invisible to appearance.

The supreme great wonder — the Glorious Great Yoginī Tantra, King of Tantras, King Supreme, the Lamp of Wondrous Suchness — is complete.

This was translated, edited, and definitively established by the great Indian paṇḍita Prajñāśrīgupta. At a later time it was translated, edited, and made pure at the hermitage of the glorious Sakya.

## Translator's Notes

- The passage presents unusually dense Vajrayāna technical idiom throughout. Several phrases present genuine interpretive difficulty.

The expression "queen of heroines who rests on bliss" renders *dpa' mo'i dbang phyug ma bde rten*, which may alternatively be read as a proper epithet of a specific deity rather than a descriptive phrase; the translation preserves the descriptive sense while allowing both readings.



The phrase "the two sense faculties" for dbang po gnyis refers to the male and female generative faculties in tantric physiology, a technical usage standard in this genre.

The verse section from "Evam, mayā, and suchness itself" onward is an extremely compressed scholastic explication of tantric syllable-meaning correspondences. The rendering follows the most natural syntactic reading, but some lines admit multiple valid interpretations and their full meaning is unpacked only through commentary.

"Gnosis-drops" renders ye shes thig le, a technical tantric term (Skt. jñānabindu) for drops or seminal essences understood as carriers of gnosis in tantric physiology and symbol.

- The passage is a tantric technical description of the subtle-body channel-wheel system within the Kālacakra tradition. Several terms — such as the "thirty-two," "Ā-li," "chain-like series," "eight bodies," and "eight nights" — are highly technical Kālacakra interior-yoga terms whose precise referents are established only by the root tantra and its commentaries. The rendering follows the most standard reading in that commentarial tradition.

The final line "Whatever is the ultimate burnt offering" is where the Tibetan passage ends mid-sentence; it is left open as in the source.

- The term torya is a technical tantric term, possibly a Sanskrit rendering of a specific stage of bliss or a ritual term; its precise identity in the context of the four joys is uncertain. It may refer to the fourth joy in some non-standard enumeration, and the Sanskrit form is unclear from the Tibetan alone.

The phrase rendered "extended verse" translates a term that in context likely refers to a specific ritual or textual unit, possibly a verse-form of instruction whose precise technical identity may vary by commentary tradition.

The phrase "bird-faced one" likely refers to a specific ḍākinī, possibly Krodhakālī or a similar deity with an animal face; the text does not name her explicitly.

- The passage enumerates a system of forty stations or attainments correlated with the thirty-two and later forty divisions of great bliss, mapped onto the bodhisattva grounds and the four joys of tantric experience. The "thirty-two hours" is a rendering of chu tshod sum cu rtsa gnyis, referring to a unit of time in classical Indian reckoning equivalent to a full day-night cycle of thirty-two such units; this is a technical tantric physiological time-frame. The "eight-petaled center" refers to the eight-petaled lotus at the heart in tantric subtle-body physiology. The "three luminosities" refers to the three experiences of appearance, increase, and attainment that arise in the dissolution of the winds in advanced completion stage practice. The "Dharma cloud" is the tenth bodhisattva ground. The phrase "universally proclaimed ground" renders kun du bod sa, which may be a term for a level beyond the tenth ground in this tantric schema.
- The passage is a Vajrayāna tantric text containing esoteric instructions on the four luminances and the stages of the empowerment sequence. Several lines present compressed and deliberately ambiguous tantric terminology. The phrase rendered "arisen from gnosis is bliss at the navel" and the surrounding anatomical-sequential mapping of gnosis, throat, heart, and mouth follow the standard completion-stage physiology of Inner Tantra, though the exact text appears to use this schema in a slightly variant order. The rendering follows the most doctrinally coherent reading.

The line "like amṛta within fat" is an unusual simile. The Tibetan reads literally "in fat, like amṛta," suggesting a hidden nectar within an outer medium — a standard tantric image for the hidden nature of gnosis within appearances.

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end with "when from that the life-force moves on," as the supplied Tibetan ends there.

- The passage belongs to a tantra presenting the four luminances in terms of an inner physiology of bliss, time, and gnosis, with the luminances correlated with daytime, nighttime, the boundary-moment, and the moon or sun. The cosmological and physiological imagery is deliberately esoteric. Several lines are intentionally polysemic and compressed; renderings given here follow the most coherent doctrinal reading.

"Legyes" renders ལེག་ཡེ་སྒྲུབ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་, which appears to be either a proper name or an epithet of the goddess interlocutor; it has been left in transliterated form because its meaning as a name ("one delighting in excellence") is used as a wordplay within the verse and a parenthetical gloss would disrupt the TTS flow. The name may deserve a note for scholars: it functions as both a name and a description.

The phrase "free from the four" in the line about unsurpassed gnosis most likely refers to the four joys or four luminances discussed in context, though it could also refer to the four extremes; the former is more probable given the surrounding discussion.

- The line "emptiness that is not emptiness, consummated by the light of the highest and the other highest" is doctrinally dense and the Tibetan somewhat compressed. "The highest and the other highest" likely refers to the ultimate and the relatively supreme, or possibly to two tantric consorts or levels of gnosis; no single standard commentarial reading is certain here, and the rendering keeps the ambiguity of the original.

The phrase rendered "a number of blessed ones equal to the dust-motes of the sun above Mount Meru" is unusual; it may mean blessed ones as numerous as the dust-particles in a beam of sunlight above Meru, a common hyperbolic enumeration in tantric literature.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.